



SAFE

Leftovers are safe when cooled and stored properly in the refrigerator below 40°F quickly. Covering the food keeps it clean and prevents spreading germs. Eating leftovers within a few days helps ensure they are still good to eat.

Source: EM 9331 Survival basics food



NOT SAFE

A jar that is not sealed properly can let harmful bacteria grow, making the food unsafe. Signs like bubbles, bad smells, or changes in color mean the food might be spoiled and should never be tasted. It's safer to throw the jar away to avoid getting sick.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



IT DEPENDS

Food like potato salad is perishable and should not be left in the 'danger zone' between 40°F and 140°F for more than 2 hours. It depends on how long the salad was out and if it was kept cold enough. If it has been longer than 2 hours at warm temperatures, it's safer to throw it out to avoid getting sick.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



SAFE

When a grown-up follows the recipe and seals the jars properly, canning peaches is safe. This is because peaches have natural acids that help keep the food safe inside the jar.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



NOT SAFE

When jars have old or bent lids and aren't closed tightly, air and germs can get inside. This can make the apples go bad and unsafe to eat. It's important for grown-ups to use new lids and make sure the jars are sealed well before putting them away.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



IT DEPENDS

Even if the jar looks sealed and was stored well, not processing the pears long enough can mean harmful bacteria or toxins might still be in the jar. The safety depends on whether the processing time was enough to kill all bacteria. If not, it's best not to eat the fruit and instead reprocess or throw it away.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



SAFE

This salsa is safe because the grown-up used a recipe that's been tested to keep food safe. The lemon juice and vinegar help stop bad germs from growing, and heating the jars properly makes sure they're sealed well so the salsa stays fresh.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



NOT SAFE

Without vinegar or lemon juice, the salsa might not be safe because some germs can still grow. And if the jars aren't boiled, those germs might not be killed. Even if the salsa looks and smells okay, it can still make you very sick.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



IT DEPENDS

These tomatoes might be safe if they were canned using a tested recipe with enough acid and processed in a boiling water canner. But if the process wasn't done right, or the acidity is low, harmful bacteria could grow. Without knowing the canning method and if the jar was sealed and stored properly, it's best to be cautious.

Source: PNW 395 Salsa recipes for canning



SAFE

Meat needs to be prepared with the right tools and steps to keep it safe. Since your grown-up follows the recipe carefully and stores the jars properly, the food will be safe to eat.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game



NOT SAFE

Meat stew is a type of food that needs a special way to be preserved safely. This special method uses a tool that gets hotter than boiling water to make sure all harmful germs are gone. Just using boiling water isn't enough to keep meat stew safe to eat. So, if a grown-up didn't use the right special tool, the stew might still be unsafe, even if the jars look okay.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game



IT DEPENDS

Green beans need careful cooking to be stored safely for a long time because they don't have much acid. If your family didn't use the special cooker but cooled the jars quickly in the fridge, the beans might be safe only for a few days. After that, they might not be safe to eat, so it's important to check with a grown-up before trying them.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game



SAFE

Quick pickles are safe when you use vinegar with at least 5% acidity and follow the recipe exactly, especially the vinegar amount. Keeping pickles refrigerated also stops harmful bacteria from growing.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



NOT SAFE

Pickled fish must be stored in the refrigerator and pickled with enough vinegar. Leaving it unrefrigerated for a week or with too little vinegar lets dangerous bacteria grow, making it unsafe to eat.

Source: PNW 183 Pickling fish and other aquatic foods



IT DEPENDS

Using pickling lime to firm cucumbers can be safe only if the cucumbers are rinsed 3 times to remove extra lime. If not rinsed well, the lime can cause health problems, so you need to check if rinsing was done correctly.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



SAFE

When a grown-up follows a tested recipe and uses clean jars sealed right away, it helps keep the jam safe from going bad. The sugar and pectin help make the jam thick and stop mold or bacteria from growing. Keeping everything clean and sealed helps the jam stay fresh for a long time.

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



NOT SAFE

Mold on jams or jellies means the whole jar could be unsafe, even if you only see mold on top. The mold may have spread below the surface or made harmful toxins. It's best to throw moldy jam away to avoid getting sick.

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



IT DEPENDS

Freezer jams must have enough sugar or acid to prevent bacteria growth. Using less sugar can be safe only if the recipe is made for low-sugar freezer jam and you keep the jam frozen or very cold. If not kept cold or if the recipe isn't tested for safety, it might spoil.

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



SAFE

Blanching green beans by briefly boiling them before freezing helps keep them fresh and good to eat. Packing the beans in airtight bags and freezing at the right temperature stops bacteria from growing, so the beans can stay safe for several months.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



NOT SAFE

Leaving frozen or refrigerated foods at room temperature too long lets harmful bacteria multiply quickly. Refreezing thawed food without cooking it first can keep bacteria alive and might cause food poisoning.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



IT DEPENDS

It depends. If the soup is still frozen or very cold, it's usually safe to keep it by putting it in the fridge or freezer again. But if the soup has warmed up to room temperature, it's safer to throw it away to avoid getting sick.

Source: PNW 296 Freezing convenience foods that you've prepared at home



SAFE

This is safe because drying removes moisture that bacteria need to grow. Keeping dried fruit in a sealed container away from light and heat keeps it fresh and safe to eat. It's important that the drying temperature was right and the fruit was fully dried to stop germs from growing.

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables



NOT SAFE

Jerky must be heated enough to kill harmful bacteria-usually to 160°F. If it isn't heated properly, the jerky can still have dangerous germs. Also, jerky left out too long without proper drying or heating can spoil and cause sickness.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely



IT DEPENDS

Smoking fish can be safe when the smoker stays warm enough to keep germs from growing. If the smoker gets too cool for some time, germs might grow and make the fish unsafe to eat. So, it depends on how long the smoker was too cool and if the grown-up made sure the fish was cooked well after.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home